

PYRAMID SHIPPING, INC.

2200 SECAUCUS ROAD
NORTH BERGEN, NJ 07047

TEL: 201-348-6300
FAX: 201-348-6262

RECEIVED

JUN 19 2017

Federal Maritime Commission
Office of Secretary

June 12, 2017

Federal Maritime Commission
800 North Capitol Street N.W.
Washington, DC 20573

Re: Docket No. 17-04 Regulatory Reform Initiative

To Whom It May Concern:

I am writing my comments below regarding the above docket number.

Since the Shipping Act of 1984, we, NVO's throughout the world, have to file ocean freight rates, some of the rules over time have changed, but the main emphasis is rate filing. Obviously, this is restrictive, as we cannot do business until the rate is filed. At one time, if we wanted an increase, we had to wait thirty days, and when it was a reduction, we could file on an immediate filing basis.

I am sure you can imagine, there are thousands of NVO's filing rates with the FMC in order for them to secure a piece of business. What other industry is faced with this burden?

We, in the transportation department, deal not only with ocean, we deal with rail, truck, air and in most cases, we are dealing with the same shippers or consignees. None of these industries require a rate filing. What makes ocean freight different? We, as a NVO, provide a service; we are the intermediate between the customer and the carrier, regardless of the mode of transportation.

As I have stated above, thousands of NVO's are filing rates, wasting thousands of man hours, without any productivity benefit. I have to question what is the need for filing rates.

June 12, 2017

It is my understanding that regulations made by a government agency, that the purpose is to protect the parties using the service, whether it would be to pursue transportation or a product. As stated, this regulation does not meet this criteria.

I beseech you to eliminate this burdensome, costly regulation.

Regards,

A handwritten signature in black ink, appearing to read "F. V. Folise", with a long horizontal flourish extending to the left.

Frank V. Folise

FVF/aw